

4.1 Waves and quantum behaviour

Learning outcomes	Additional guidance
(a) <i>Describe and explain:</i>	
(i) production of standing waves by waves travelling in opposite directions	Including graphical treatment HSW1, 2
(ii) interference of waves from two slits	
(iii) refraction of light at a plane boundary in terms of the changes in the speed of light and explanation in terms of the wave model of light	M0.2
(iv) diffraction of waves passing through a narrow aperture	HSW6
(v) diffraction by a grating	
(vi) evidence that photons exchange energy in quanta $E = hf$ (for example, one of light-emitting diodes, photoelectric effect and line spectra)	limitations of particle and wave models HSW7, 11 M3.1, M3.2, M3.3, M3.4
(vii) quantum behaviour: quanta have a certain probability of arrival; the probability is obtained by combining amplitude and phase for all possible paths	M1.3
(viii) evidence from electron diffraction that electrons show quantum behaviour.	HSW7, 11

- (b)** *Make appropriate use of:*
- (i)** the terms: phase, phasor, amplitude, probability, interference, diffraction, superposition, coherence, path difference, intensity, electronvolt, refractive index, work function, threshold frequency.
- (c)** *Make calculations and estimates involving:*
- (i)** wavelength of standing waves end corrections not required
 - (ii)** Snell's Law, $n = \frac{\sin i}{\sin r} = \frac{C_{1\text{st medium}}}{C_{2\text{nd medium}}}$ *M03, M0.6, M4.5*
 - (iii)** path differences for double slits and diffraction grating, for constructive interference $n\lambda = d \sin \theta$ (both limited to the case of a distant screen) angles may be given in degrees or radians, the use of the small angle approximation is expected.
M0.6, M4.6, M4.7
 - (iv)** the energy carried by photons across the spectrum, $E = hf$ *M0.2, M2.3*
 - (v)** the wavelength of a particle of momentum p , $\lambda = \frac{h}{p}$ As given by the de Broglie relationship
M0.2, M2.3
- (d)** *Demonstrate and apply knowledge and understanding of the following practical activities (HSW4):*
- (i)** using an oscilloscope to determine frequencies links to **4.1a(i)**
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 - (ii)** determining refractive index for a transparent block links to **4.1c(ii)**
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 - (iii)** superposition experiments using vibrating strings, sound waves, light and microwaves links to **4.1a(i), b(i), c(i)**
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 - (iv)** determining the wavelength of light with a double-slit and diffraction grating links to **4.1a(ii), a(v), c(iii)**
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 - (v)** determining the speed of sound in air by formation of stationary waves in a resonance tube links to **4.1a(i), c(i)**
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 - (vi)** determining the Planck constant using different coloured LEDs. links to **4.1a(vi), c(iv)**
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